

Feedback for Operating Systems – Question 1

The overall marks on this exam had a relatively wide spread, with results showing that most marks were deducted on questions relating to higher tiers in Bloom's taxonomy.

- 1a) + 1b) + 1c): There were no major issues in these parts.
- 1d): Some students attempted to describe the execution trace in prose instead of a tabular format. Another common source of mistakes was the incorrect handling of the semaphores.
- 1e): A common mistake here was not to check for the case when there are no tasks to run next.

Feedback for Operating Systems – Question 2

The overall marks on this exam had a relatively wide spread, with results showing that most marks were deducted on questions relating to higher tiers in Bloom's taxonomy.

- 2a) Marks were lost for misunderstanding the role of each bit in the page table, and how the hardware MMU uses them. Marks were also lost for not counting the number of memory accesses in 2biii (in addition to the number of TLB hits).
- 2b) Full marks required identifying the adequate disk I/O mode, but also showing the understanding of the differences between buffered and unbuffered I/O (for which marks were deducted).
- 2c) Marks were deducted for not showing an understanding of how soft links work.